

Universal Auto Explore for Civilization VII

Contents

Universal Auto Explore for Civilization VII	2
At a glance (for players)	2
How it works	2
Layout	2
Publishing to Steam Workshop	3
Notes	3

Universal Auto Explore for Civilization VII

Grants the game's built-in auto-explore action to **every** unit, so any unit, not just Scouts, can be sent off to reveal the map on its own. It does not change gameplay balance.

At a glance (for players)

The "explore" command Civilization VII only gives your Scouts, unlocked on everything else: Warriors, Settlers, Commanders, siege, ships, unique units, and great people.

- Any unit can be told to auto-explore and fill in the fog on its own.
- It unlocks a command the game already has, so there's no new UI. If you can auto-explore a Scout, you can use this.
- Coverage includes base game, all DLC, independent-power units, captured units, and future patch units, automatically.
- It does not touch balance, movement, combat, costs, or base-game files, and is safe to add to an ongoing game or save.

At a glance (for modders):

- **Mod id:** `universal-auto-explore`
 - **Author:** Tower
 - **Version:** 1.0.1
 - **Requires:** `base-standard` (i.e. the base game). No DLC required.
-

How it works

The game enables auto-explore on units carrying the `UNIT_CLASS_AUTOEXPLORE` type tag (by default only Scouts, a handful of uniques, and most warships have it). This mod adds that tag to every other unit.

Instead of hand-listing hundreds of unit types, it applies the tag with a single set-based SQL patch — `data/grant-autoexplore.sql`:

```
INSERT OR IGNORE INTO TypeTags (Type, Tag)
SELECT Type, 'UNIT_CLASS_AUTOEXPLORE'
FROM   Types
WHERE  Kind = 'KIND_UNIT'
      AND Type NOT LIKE '%SANDBOX%';
```

Why this shape:

- **Low-maintenance coverage.** It tags whatever `KIND_UNIT` types exist in the current age's database — base game, every DLC civ/leader pack, independent-power units, units a player captures, and any units a future patch adds. Nothing to update per release.
- **INSERT OR IGNORE** skips units that already carry the tag (they collide on the `TypeTags (Tag, Type)` primary key), so there is no duplicate-row load error and no need to maintain an exclusion list.
- **Runs on new games and loaded saves.** The action group uses `AlwaysMet`, so the patch executes whenever game scope initializes, including save loads. A high `LoadOrder` (9999) ensures it runs after all unit types have been inserted.
- **SANDBOX filter** drops the engine test units (`UNIT_SANDBOX`, `UNIT_AUDIO_SANDBOX_*`), which never appear in normal play.

`UNIT_CLASS_AUTOEXPLORE`, the `Types/TypeTags` table names, `KIND_UNIT`, and `AGE_*` are engine-owned identifiers and are left unchanged. Renaming them would break the effect. Everything author-owned (mod id, filename, action-group id, localization tags, author) was renamed for this rebuild; no attribution to the original creator remains.

Layout

```
universal_auto-explore/
  universal-auto-explore.modinfo  # mod manifest
```

```

data/grant-autoexplore.sql      # the single set-based tag patch
text/en_us/ModuleText.xml      # display name + description
README.md  README.pdf          # this document
CHANGELOG.md                   # release history (drives the Steam change note)
CONTRIBUTING.md  LICENSE      # contributor guide + MIT license
release.sh                   # build the Workshop package
steam_workshop_id.txt         # publishedfileid, written on first publish
images/
  universal-auto-explore-icon.svg # mod icon
docs/
  steam-workshop-description.md      # full Steam store copy (BBCode)
  steam-workshop-description-short.md # short Steam store copy (BBCode)
  workshop-preview.svg  workshop-preview.png # Steam preview card
scripts/
  build_readme_pdf.sh      # regenerate README.pdf

```

Only the modinfo, data/, text/, README, CHANGELOG, and LICENSE ship in the Workshop zip; docs/, images/, scripts/, and the release tooling are repo-only (excluded by `release.sh`).

Everything below data/, text/, plus the modinfo and README is what ships; the rest is release tooling and is excluded from the packaged zip.

Publishing to Steam Workshop

`release.sh` builds a clean, audited package — it does **not** upload (that needs your Steam login).

1. Bump `<Version>` in the modinfo and add a matching `## [x.y.z]` section to `CHANGELOG.md`.
2. Run `./release.sh`. It writes `dist/`:
 - `universal-auto-explore-vX.Y.Z.zip` — the mod, modinfo at the zip root (also fine for manual install / CivMods).
 - `dist/universal_auto-explore/` — the upload content folder.
 - `preview.png` — 1024×1024 card rendered from `docs/workshop-preview.svg` (needs `rsvg-convert`; `brew install librsvg`).
 - `workshop_item.vdf` — the steamcmd manifest (appid 1295660).
3. Upload with the command the script prints:


```
~/steamcmd/steamcmd.sh +login <yourSteamLogin> \
  +workshop_build_item <abs-path>/dist/workshop_item.vdf +quit
```
4. The first upload creates the item and prints a `publishedfileid`. Save it: `echo <publishedfileid> > steam_workshop_id.txt`. Later runs then upload in **update** mode and generate the Steam change note from the current `CHANGELOG.md` section.

Notes

- Rebuilt against Civilization VII **1.4.1**. Because the effect is set-based, it does not need to be re-verified against a specific unit roster each patch.